

Mark Ward

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Professional Profile

Pragmatic Senior Engineer and SaaS Architect with 15+ years of experience building, scaling, and modernizing web platforms. Specializes in multi-tenant architectures, complex data modeling, and highly reliable backend systems. Leads technical strategy and mentors teams while remaining a heavy, hands-on code contributor. Prioritizes clean, maintainable code, rigorous testing, and scalable architecture over quick fixes to ensure systems perform under pressure.

Core Technical Stack

Back-End & Data	Node.js, PHP 8.x, Laravel, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Complex Data Modeling, REST/GraphQL APIs
Front-End	TypeScript, React, Next.js, HTML/CSS, Tailwind CSS, Microfrontend Architecture
Infra & Workflow	AWS, CI/CD, Git, TDD, AI-Assisted Engineering (Claude Code, Cursor)

Professional Experience

Lead Engineer | Third and Grove (Sept 2022 – Present)

- Architected and led major enterprise-level headless migrations for high-profile clients, including California Closets, delivering scalable front-end systems with optimized performance metrics.
- Manage and mentor remote development teams, overseeing technical grooming, feature estimations, and architectural decisions while operating as a heavy individual code contributor.
- Champion the use of agentic AI tools (Cursor, Claude Code) within terminal-based workflows to systematically refactor legacy code and accelerate development velocity by an estimated 30%.
- Establish and enforce technical standards across the engineering department through rigorous code reviews, prioritizing maintainable MVC architecture and data integrity.

Principal Technical Consultant & SaaS Architect | Mark Ward Design (2007 – Present)

- Operate as a fractional CTO and Lead Engineer, architecting end-to-end SaaS solutions from MVP to scale in ambiguous, fast-paced environments.
- **M.I.L.E.S.:** Engineered a multi-tenant platform for the automotive industry, managing complex PostgreSQL data modeling, role-based access, and secure routing for high-volume environments.
- **CropAide.com:** Built a data-driven agricultural management platform using Laravel and MySQL to translate fragmented field data and irrigation plans into real-time operational dashboards.
- **ProjectAire.app:** Developed a comprehensive construction management application designed to streamline complex project tracking, resource allocation, and team collaboration.

Web Strategy Lead / Senior Full Stack Developer | Empowered Education (2018 – 2022)

- Led the complex migration of legacy monoliths to modern, API-driven architectures, significantly improving system scalability and reliability.
- Directed full-stack development teams and managed external contractors to execute major platform overhauls for a large organization.
- Championed a culture of test-driven development (TDD) and automated testing workflows, successfully reducing production regressions by 40%.

Coaching & Community Leadership

Boys' Basketball Coach | Kimberly High School District (2015 – Present)

- Lead a state-caliber high school program, focusing on fundamentals, execution, and fostering a culture of hard work and stewardship among student-athletes.
- Apply years of coaching principles to engineering leadership—unblocking teams, providing direct feedback, and building cohesive, high-performing units.

Education

Bachelor of Science: Secondary Education & Health and Human Performance

University of Montana Western